

BASIT AZEEZ

Operations, Business Systems and Transformation Leader | Builds the operating model, platforms and AI automation a scaling business runs on, and the team that sustains them

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MBA | PMP | CSM | ITIL 4 | Lean Six Sigma | Wharton AI for Business | Right to work in the UK to 2030, no sponsorship required

PROFILE

Operations and transformation leader who builds the systems an organisation needs to scale, then gets people to use them. Joined Study Now when it ran two countries on spreadsheets and built the business systems, technology and operations function from nothing: four enterprise platform migrations, a proprietary operational platform taken from ideation to the system of record across seven markets, an automation layer across Monday.com and Zapier with an AI-enabled Flow Builder now being built into the platform, a governance model for 500+ external partners, and the reporting leadership now decides from. The business grew to seven countries, nine offices, 100+ staff, 500+ partners and 1,500+ annual enrolments without the systems becoming the constraint. Leads a cross-functional team of 20 including software engineers and data analysts, both capabilities recruited into roles that did not previously exist, and holds a £500k+ technology and operations budget with the vendor estate behind it. Builds hands-on rather than specifying and delegating: writes requirements, prototypes, designs schemas and builds the automation, uses Claude Code daily, and designs Claude API steps behind confidence thresholds and human review on anything material. Trained as an architect before moving into technology, which shapes how systems, constraints and buildability are thought about.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Operating model design and delivery governance | Intake, prioritisation and portfolio sequencing | Programme and project delivery: Agile, waterfall and hybrid | Enterprise platform migration and implementation | Release governance and quality gating | Third-party, supplier and partner governance | Vendor and development partner management, including exit and insourcing | Change management, training and adoption measurement | AI and workflow automation in production, with governance | Process mapping and redesign (BPMN) | Reporting, KPI frameworks and delivery flow metrics | Multi-country compliance and audit readiness | Team building, hiring and coaching | Budget ownership (£500k+)

Stack: Claude API, Claude Code, MCP, RAG, LangGraph, OpenAI, Microsoft Copilot; n8n, Make, Zapier, Power Automate, Power Platform; SQL, Python, Power BI, Tableau, Excel; React, Next.js, TypeScript, Node.js, Supabase, Vercel, GitHub; Monday.com, Element 451, BambooHR, AirTable, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace; Jira, Confluence, Asana, Smartsheet, Miro, Visio, BPMN; Revit.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Business Systems and Operations, GSP Platform

Sep 2024 to present

Study Now, London | contractual title: Digital Transformation Project Manager | international education group: 7 countries, 9 offices, 100+ staff, 500+ recruitment partners, 300,000+ student records, 1,500+ annual enrolments, 50,000+ monthly customer interactions

- Own the operating model across technology, delivery and operations: one governed intake route for every function, published prioritisation criteria agreed with department heads, release governance, delivery standards and the reporting leadership uses to decide. None of it existed on arrival; work was sequenced by whoever asked loudest and every conflict escalated upward. Non-compliance incidents fell 40% after governance and standardised workflows were introduced.
- Led GSP, the proprietary operational platform, from ideation to the system of record across 7 markets, shared with sister company Platinum. Took it from one destination to nine across the UK and Europe in six months; each carries its own application flow, visa regime and compliance rules on a shared core spanning UK and EU immigration frameworks, so the platform standardises where it can and localises where regulation requires.
- Managed the external development partner through the build lifecycle, owning requirements, HTML prototypes, acceptance criteria, quality gates and timeline, then brought development in-house by recruiting three software engineers. Now own release governance end to end, holding the quality gate on every release whilst the internal team builds the next modules.
- Designed and embedded the governance model for 500+ external recruitment partners across 7 jurisdictions: AQF-aligned onboarding and accreditation, performance standards, commercial terms and offboarding, replacing country-

by-country arrangements with one documented model built into the platform. Leading the rollout of GSP agent onboarding across all markets.

- Architecting the GSP commission engine: real-time commission tracking between the platform and 500+ agents, validated against agent tier, triggered at enrolment and on receipt of university payment, covering invoicing, reconciliation, payment acknowledgement and a running position on commission accrued, paid and outstanding across 7 markets and multiple currencies.
- Built the automation layer the business runs on: Monday.com automations covering commission statements, invoice document generation, status routing and notifications, with Zapier as the interconnector funnelling inbound leads into the operations platform. Now building GSP's own Flow Builder from scratch, with Claude API steps behind confidence thresholds, deterministic fallbacks and human review on anything material, designed so recurring patterns become deterministic rules and the model's surface area shrinks over time.
- Hold the £500k+ technology and operations budget and the vendor estate behind it: tooling selection run as a cross-functional decision with department heads, contracts and licences tracked, and the Element 451 CRM exited onto the in-house platform when the case no longer held.
- Lead a cross-functional team of 20 including 3 software engineers and 3 data analysts recruited into roles that did not previously exist; started the internal support function from scratch, hiring, structuring and leading it and defining the OKRs and KPIs it is measured against.
- Own compliance governance across UKVI CAS and visa requirements and AQF accreditation, with documented process, audit-ready records and external audit support across multiple countries.
- Built the reporting layer in Power BI, Tableau and SQL covering delivery progress, adoption, capacity, support trends and where customer journeys break, replacing spreadsheets rebuilt each cycle; used it to show the director that capacity, not prioritisation, was the delivery constraint, which changed how the roadmap was resourced. Own marketing performance measurement, attribution, lead quality and channel effectiveness through Element 451 with the commercial and partner teams.
- Retire process that has stopped earning its place: a framework people work around costs more than no framework, so the test applied is whether teams follow it without being chased.

Operations Manager, Business Systems (Monday.com and GSP)

Apr 2023 to Sep 2024

Study Now, London | hired as Operations Manager

- Delivered four enterprise platform migrations as the business scaled from 2 countries to 7: Excel to Monday.com as the first operational platform with automation logic configured and 500+ agents trained; Google Workspace to Microsoft 365 with zero critical downtime; BambooHR across 100+ staff with full audit readiness; and Monday.com to the proprietary GSP platform with workflows redesigned in every market.
- Designed the organisation's first intake, prioritisation and delivery governance model across every business function, with planning standards, estimation norms and definitions of done.
- Led four concurrent programmes across interrelated workstreams, managing dependencies and risk and holding external development partners to scope, cost and timeline.
- Introduced the first workflow automation across compliance, partner onboarding and financial reconciliation, each scoped with success criteria before build and tracked afterwards; built the first Power BI and SQL reporting that made delivery and operational performance visible to leadership.

Technical Delivery Manager

Mar 2021 to Nov 2022

Getir, Germany | founding operations team for the German market launch of a rapid-delivery scale-up

- Supported rapid expansion into the German market during one of the fastest scaling periods in European technology, working across engineering, commercial and frontline operations under constant priority change.
- Built the delivery performance measurement and reporting infrastructure that exposed operational constraints and gave leadership real-time visibility across markets; coordinated delivery across concurrent workstreams in a high-volume, multi-site environment and led adoption of digital order-management tooling by 100+ frontline staff.

Operations and Delivery Manager

Jan 2020 to Mar 2021

Development Hub Consulting, Germany and remote | embedded with an agri-tech marketplace start-up

- Led the operational and systems set-up for a marketplace platform launch, translating business requirements into scoped, sequenced deliverables across a distributed engineering team and external technology partners; owned delivery planning, dependencies and risk, and established the documentation, training and reporting frameworks the client continued to use after the engagement.

Earlier career, Nigeria

2015 to 2019

- Product Manager, Point Ace Konsults; Project Manager, Sales and Marketing, GALCON Engineering; Project Architect, Total Consults.

BUILT AND SHIPPED

- GSP Platform | Study Now system of record across 7 markets, serving the 500+ partner network and direct applicants. Owned end to end from requirements and HTML prototyping through partner coordination, architecture decisions and acceptance sign-off, then internalised development. Includes AQF-aligned agent onboarding, commission management with bidirectional validation, stage-length SLA monitoring, CAS and visa compliance tracking, and a role-scoped Help Center.
- GSP Commission Engine | In design and build. Two-sided real-time commission system with tier-based validation, event-driven triggers at enrolment and university payment, invoicing, reconciliation and a running position across 7 markets and multiple currencies.
- Automation Layer and GSP Flow Builder | Live on Monday.com and Zapier: commission statements, invoice documents, status routing, notifications, and inbound leads funnelled into the operations platform. In build: GSP's own Flow Builder, with Claude API steps behind confidence thresholds, value limits and human review queues.
- Custom Claude Code Skills | Markdown skills for CLI and desktop so repeatable delivery, governance and analysis work runs to one standard across the team rather than depending on one person.
- Deposit Tracker | Real-time multi-currency reconciliation across 7 markets, replacing a manual process that occupied two people for several days a month; built after running the manual process personally to find where it broke. React, Vite, Supabase, TypeScript.
- Employee Voting App | HR governance tool with Nigeria and Global tracks, role-based access and an admin portal HR configures monthly without a developer. Next.js, Supabase, Vercel.
- Shuqs | shuqs.vercel.app | Progressive web app built and shipped independently: onboarding, batch actions, Supabase authentication with cross-device sync, push notifications. React, PWA, Supabase, TypeScript.
- Isiro | isiro-sigma.vercel.app | Personal finance PWA built around a structured allocation principle. React, Vite, Supabase, Vercel.

EDUCATION

MBA, Quantic School of Business and Technology (2021 to 2022) | **MA Architectural and Cultural Heritage**, Hochschule Anhalt, Dessau-Rosslau, Germany (2018 to 2021) | **BTech Architecture**, Federal University of Technology, Akure, Nigeria (2010 to 2015)

CERTIFICATIONS AND MEMBERSHIPS

Project Management Professional (PMP), PMI, 2022 | Certified Scrum Master (CSM), Scrum Alliance | ITIL 4 Foundation, PeopleCert, Mar 2026 | AI for Business Specialization, Wharton School, Jul 2025 | Lean Six Sigma White Belt, Management & Strategy Institute, Oct 2022 | Professional Member, Association for Project Management, Aug 2024 | Monday.com Core Certification

WRITING

Writes on operations, systems thinking and building technology at zealenigma.substack.com, including why most process improvement efforts fail before they start, the difference between an operating system and a tool stack, and building things you were never trained to build.